

Cover



GLOBAL GOALS

JAM
The Playbook

The guide to hosting a jam — the plan, the room, the weekend, and what happens after.

globalgoalsjam.org Hosted in 60+ countries · Co-founded with UNDP

Before you begin

Before you book a venue

You do not need permission.

In 2015 the world agreed on seventeen goals — clean water, good jobs, liveable cities, a stable climate — and gave itself until 2030. Then most people went back to waiting: for governments, for institutions, for somebody more qualified. The Global Goals Jam was founded on the opposite bet: **anyone can work on the Global Goals.**

The bet has held. Since 2016, when the Digital Society School in Amsterdam co-founded the jam with UNDP, hosts in more than 60 countries have filled rooms with students, civil servants, designers, shopkeepers and neighbours — and spent a weekend making things for the goals as they show up in their own streets.

This book is the how. Seven chapters take you from “someone should really run a jam here” to a room of working teams — and to the Monday after, when the work either travels or stalls. No jam experience required. A room, a date and this playbook will do.

It pairs with the **GGJ Host Programme** at learn.globalgoalsjam.org. The book shows you what good looks like; the programme makes you build it — nine modules, each ending in an artefact, stacking into your complete jam plan.

The goals are global. The hands are local.

Global Goals Jam · co-founded with UNDP at the Digital Society School, Amsterdam · 2016

The Global Goals Jam Playbook02

What's inside

Seven chapters and one promise: everything you need to host an amazing jam for the Global Goals — and to keep its momentum alive after the weekend.

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How to read this

Start here

Three ways in, depending on when this book finds you.

Dreaming about hosting

Read it cover to cover; an evening is enough. Chapter 01 tells you what you would be joining, chapter 03 what it costs in weeks. If you finish and the answer is still yes, pick a date before you close the book.

Inside the Host Programme

Each chapter carries a green **In the programme** line naming its modules. Read the chapter for the idea, then do the module's Apply worksheet — the artefacts you build there stack into your jam plan at the capstone.

Jam week

Go straight to chapters 06 and 07. The timelines and the checklist were written for the seven days before doors open, when nobody has time to read anything twice.

Book and programme, one method. The programme's nine modules run on the same 4-sprint spine as this book (chapter 04). Wherever a page says a module “generates” or “builds” something, that is the Apply worksheet doing the work with you at learn.globalgoalsjam.org.

One habit before all three

Read with a pen. Chapter 07 and the host scan are made to be written in — decisions exist when they are written down, not when they are thought.

How to use this04

Global goals. Local hands.

A Global Goals Jam is a short, structured burst of making: mixed teams, a real local challenge, and the UN Sustainable Development Goals as the brief. In one to three days a team goes from meeting a challenge to testing a prototype with the people who live it. Chapter 04 shows exactly how.

The format was designed to work as well in Hyderabad as in Hamburg. That is the quiet power of hosting one: your jam is entirely local — your food-waste problem, your neighbourhood, your municipality — and at the same time one node in a worldwide effort, sharing methods openly and publishing what it makes.

60+ countries have hosted a jam.

Yours can be next.

Anyone can work on the Global Goals. Hosting a jam is how you prove it to your city.

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What a jam changes.

Global impact, local action

Every local jam contributes to a global understanding of how the same challenge shows up across cultures and contexts. Empathy, momentum and collaboration scale sideways — host to host, city to city — because everything a jam makes is shared openly.

Diverse collaboration

Students, professionals and community members learn together, prototype together, and publish what they make. The mix is the method: a room of one discipline designs for itself; a mixed room designs for the city.

150+Cities

10,000+Jammers

17Global Goals

Any

weekendYear-round

Now year-round

Jams used to cluster around one global weekend in September. You can now host at any time of year, aligned with your local calendar and campaigns — and the September slipstream is still there if you want the company.

In the programme**Module 1 · Welcome to the Jam** opens with this story and asks for your first decision: the date. **Module 2 · Systems & the Goals** anchors your challenge to one SDG target you can quote.

Your jamkit, generated

You do not design your jam from a blank page. The Toolkit Generator on **globalgoalsjam.org/toolkit** takes your challenge, SDG focus, duration and crowd, and produces a complete, printable jamkit. You stay on our platform — no separate accounts — with Metodic powering the method engine behind the scenes.

What it creates

- A context-aware facilitation guide, written for your jam, not a generic one.
- Method cards for every sprint, ready to hand to teams.
- Templates and worksheets for the work itself (chapter 07 tours the pack).
- Time-optimised schedules for your exact duration.
- Instructions tuned to your group's experience level.

How to use it

- Step 01
 - Open Toolkit → Generator on globalgoalsjam.org (host access required).
- Step 02
 - Enter your challenge, SDG focus, duration and participant count.
- Step 03
 - Add local context: partners, venue quirks, the resources you actually have.
- Step 04
 - Generate, review, adapt — then export as HTML or PDF and print the pack.

In the programme**Module 4 · The Jamkit & Your Agenda** walks the kit end to end, then its Apply worksheet turns the generator's output into your agenda — every adaptation noted, with its reason.

Chapter 02 · The toolkit generator07

Three jams, three toolkits.

The same generator, three very different days. Steal the shape: a specific challenge, a named crowd, one real local resource.

11

Amsterdam · SDG 11 · 2 days · 25 jammers, mixed ages

“How might we reduce food waste in urban neighbourhoods while building community connections?”

With a food bank as challenge partner, the kit opened on a neighbourhood food-waste mapping walk, moved through ideation on composting and sharing, and closed day two testing prototypes with residents.

4

Rural Kenya · SDG 4 · 1-day intensive · 15 teachers & tech volunteers

“How might we improve access to digital learning for students without reliable internet?”

A solar charging station and offline tablets set the constraints: context immersion at 09:00, offline-first ideation at 11:00, building and testing offline content packages with students by 14:00.

13

Singapore · SDG 13 · 3-day sprint · 30 business owners, designers, engineers

“How might we help small businesses reduce their carbon footprint affordably?”

Three days bought depth: carbon-footprint mapping to find the biggest impact areas, a cost-benefit matrix to rank solutions, stakeholder journey maps, and prototypes tested with real businesses.

Composite scenarios, condensed from the organiser booklet. Your generator run will name your city instead.

Get more out of the generator.

Six habits that separate a kit you follow from a kit that fits.

Input

Be specific with the challenge

Not “improve education” — “help rural teachers create engaging science lessons with limited resources.” The sharper the brief, the sharper the methods you get back.

Input

Know your participants

Expertise, age range, backgrounds. The generator tunes activities and difficulty to the crowd you actually recruited — so tell it the truth, not the crowd you hoped for.

Input

Include local context

Name your partners, cultural considerations and available resources. Local texture is what turns a generic agenda into your agenda.

Shape

Time allocation matters

A one-day jam needs focused sprints; a three-day jam earns a deeper research phase. Say how long you really have, not how long you wish you had.

On the day

Adapt on the fly

The kit is a foundation, not a contract. Adjust to the room's energy and progress — and note why, so next year's you inherits the lesson.

On the day

Plan for documentation

Name someone to capture insights, photos and quotes before the jam starts. The kit includes templates for exactly this; chapter 07 has the consent line.

Done when

A generated kit exists that names your city, your crowd and your duration — and you have walked its agenda once, slowly, as a participant would.

Chapter 02 · The toolkit generator09

Start 8–12 weeks out

A jam without a date is a mood. Put a weekend in the calendar first; everything below counts backwards from it.

Weeks 12–8

Choose the focus

Pick one or two SDGs with strong local relevance, draft the challenge, and name a co-host — the single strongest predictor that a first jam actually happens.

Weeks 8–4

Line up the people

Confirm challenge partners and coaches, secure the venue, and define what success means: metrics and timing, written down before the adrenaline starts.

Weeks 4–1

Fill the room

Open registration and run outreach through your partners' channels, not just your own. Generate the toolkit, print the pack, brief the coaches.

Week 0

Run it

Chapter 06 has your weekend hour by hour. Chapter 07 has the final checklist.

In the programmeModules 1–3 carry these weeks: the date and intention (**Module 1**), the challenge anchored to an SDG target (**Module 2**), and the partner & venue shortlist with the ask written out (**Module 3**).

The room and the kit.

The venue

A flexible space for 15–40 participants, with room for teams of 4–6 to spread out and think aloud without shouting over each other. Strong Wi-Fi and projection for kickoff and presentations. Walls or boards you are allowed to fill — posted work makes progress visible and walk-by feedback cheap.

The materials

Toolkit printouts for every team — method cards, templates, schedules — plus the analogue stack that never crashes: markers, sticky notes, tape, name tags. Food and coffee are planned like part of the method, because they are (chapter 06).

Why 4–6

Small enough that nobody can hide, large enough to carry a prototype through a weekend. Mix disciplines and backgrounds deliberately — chapter 05 is about exactly that.

Done when

A stranger could arrive at 08:45 on jam day and find the room ready: kit printed, walls clear, projector tested, coffee on.

Four sprints. One weekend.

The jam runs on a design-sprint spine: four timeboxed sprints over one to three days. **Understand** the challenge and the people living it. **Define** the opportunity worth a weekend. **Prototype** something real enough to test. **Implement** — present, hand over, and send the results travelling.

The timeboxes are not there to rush anyone. They are your safety net: at 14:00 on Saturday, when a team is stuck or a discussion runs circular, the sprint decides what happens next — so you do not have to argue for it. Day one belongs to exploring and defining; day two to making, testing and sharing.

You own the how. The teams own the what.

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The four sprints

Each sprint closes with something a team can show, not just say.

1

Sprint 1

Understand — meet the challenge where it lives

Kickoff and challenge framing · team formation · field research and interviews · insight synthesis

Closes when: the team can retell the challenge in the words of someone who lives it.

2

Sprint 2

Define — choose the opportunity

Cluster the insights · frame the “how might we” · pick one direction on purpose, not three by accident

Closes when: one sharp question is on the wall, and the team can say why this one.

3

Sprint 3

Prototype — make it tangible

Build the rough version fast · test with real people · iterate on what they do, not what they say

Closes when: something exists that a stranger can react to.

4

Sprint 4

Implement — make it travel

Presentations · feedback · next steps with names and dates · results published to the global network

Closes when: the work has a next owner and a next date.

In the programmeThe Host Programme runs on this exact spine: **Modules 1–2** are Sprint 1, **Modules 3–4** Sprint 2, **Modules 5–6** Sprint 3, **Modules 7–8** Sprint 4. You rehearse the method before you facilitate it.

Nobody jams alone

The quality of your jam is decided weeks earlier — by who is in the room, and who sent them.

Strategic partners

NGOs, universities, the public sector and purposeful companies supply the two things you cannot fake: real challenges, and pathways for the work after the weekend. Find the person, not the institution — a named ally beats a logo on a slide.

The participant mix

Diversity across disciplines and backgrounds is not a nice-to-have; it is what fuels better outcomes. Recruit through your partners' channels as well as your own, or you will fill the room with your own bubble — pleasant, and designing for people exactly like you.

The always-on community

Between jams, the GGJ forum and community spaces are where hosts trade formats, honest recaps and encouragement. Ask there first — a host in another timezone has already solved your problem.

In the programme**Module 3 · Open Design & Partners** turns this page into your shortlist: three partner candidates, three venues, named contacts, and the ask written as you would say it.

Keep the network warm.

What partners get matters as much as what they give. City hall gets engaged residents. The university gets real-world projects for its students. The NGO gets fresh hands on its issue. Say this out loud when you make the ask — it is the honest answer to “what is in it for us”, and it is a good answer.

Your alumni are your city's standing team. Invite them back as coaches, hand the best of them a sprint to run next year, and connect them to jams nearby — regional networks grow host by host, not by decree.

The open-design deal

Everything a jam produces is published and reusable. Your teams inherit formats from the hosts before them; your results travel to the hosts after you, across more than 60 countries. Publish, credit, reuse — that is the whole contract.

In the programme**Module 7 · Impact & Continuation** plans the 90 days after your jam: owners, hand-offs, and the next check-in with a date on it.

The one-day jam, hour by hour

- 09:00

Check-in & kickoff

Doors, coffee, names. Set the tone in ten minutes: why this challenge, why this room.

- 09:30

Challenge brief & team formation

The partner presents the challenge; mixed teams form around it.

- 10:15

Research sprint

Understand: interviews and field notes — the challenge in real people's words.

- 12:00

Lunch

Teams metabolise the morning. Eat together; the best syntheses start over food.

- 13:00

Define the opportunity

Insights on the wall; one “how might we” per team.

- 14:00

Prototype sprint

Rough, fast, testable. Paper beats pixels at this speed.

- 16:00

Test & iterate

Prototypes meet strangers; teams adjust while the feedback is still warm.

- 17:00

Presentations

Three minutes per team: challenge, insight, prototype, next step.

- 18:00

Wrap-up

Next steps with names on them, photos, thanks — and publish the results.

Two days, or three.

The 2-day jam — the classic weekend

Day 1 · morning

Kickoff & research. Brief, teams, field research — Sprint 1 in full.

Day 1 · afternoon

Define & concept. Insights to one direction; first concept sketches before dinner.

Day 2 · morning

Prototype. Build the testable version.

Day 2 · afternoon

Test, iterate, present. Strangers react, teams adjust, three-minute pitches close the weekend.

The 3-day jam — room to go deep

Day 1

Explore the problem space. A full day of Understand and Define: more field time, better questions.

Day 2

Prototype & test. Build in the morning, test in the afternoon, iterate before dinner.

Day 3

Iterate & present. Second test round, final builds, presentations and next-step commitments.

In the programme **Module 4 generates this agenda for you** — tuned to your duration, team size and venue — and its Apply worksheet adds the energy layer: breaks, music, food, and your own off-floor window.

The host checklist

Run it in the final week. Every box gets a tick and a name next to it — hosting is delegation with a smile.

- **Venue confirmed.** Wi-Fi tested from a participant seat, projection works, step-free access checked.

Owner

- **Coaches & lightning speakers.** Recruited, briefed, and they know which sprint they serve.

Owner

- **Registration & communications.** Published, reminders scheduled, participants know where the door is.

Owner

- **Materials.** Toolkit printouts per team, markers, sticky notes, tape, name tags.

Owner

- **Consent & documentation.** Photo consent at check-in; someone owns capture — photos, quotes, results.

Owner

- **Food & coffee.** Ordered for the real headcount, dietary needs asked at registration.

Owner

Done when

Every box is ticked and at least three of the owner lines carry a name that is not yours.

The team template pack.

Five sheets every team gets on paper. The generator bundles them (chapter 02); tailor them to your context.

- 01

Challenge brief sheet

The challenge, the SDG focus, the partner and the constraints — on one page a team can keep in view.

- 02

Assumption map

What the team believes but has not checked. It is the research sprint's shopping list.

- 03

Storyboard template

The idea as six frames: who, where, what changes.

- 04

Test interview guide

Questions that invite honesty, not compliments.

- 05

Pitch outline

Three minutes: challenge, insight, prototype, next step.

Print tip. In Toolkit → Generator, tick “Include printable pack” to auto-bundle every template your plan needs, sized to your team count.

In the programme**Module 8 · Capstone** assembles the artefacts you built in Modules 1–7 into one runnable jam plan — and you pitch it to the Facilitator before your real weekend.

Your baseline · before chapter 01, or at day 90

The host scan

Six competencies every host builds. Score each 0–3, honestly — nobody grades this, and low-and-honest beats high-and-hopeful.

0 not yet true · **1** I have read about it · **2** done once, or partly · **3** true in practice — I could teach it

- S

Systems & SDG framing. I can take a city frustration and anchor it to one SDG target I can quote.

0 1 2 3

- D

Jam design. I can shape a 4-sprint agenda that fits my duration, room and crowd.

0 1 2 3

- F

Facilitation & energy. I can run a room without dominating it, and I have a plan for the energy dip.

0 1 2 3

- I

Inclusion & safety. I can recruit beyond my own bubble and keep the room safe to think in.

0 1 2 3

- P

Partnerships & logistics. I have partners, a venue and an ask I can say out loud.

0 1 2 3

- C

Impact & continuation. I measure output, not attendance — and the work has owners after the weekend.

0 1 2 3

Total today/ 18 Date

In the programme**Module 0** runs this same scan as your baseline; the capstone re-runs it at day 90. The delta matters more than either number.

Back cover

The weekend ends.

The work travels.

If you hosted with this book, your city now has prototypes, a network that did not exist on Friday, and proof that anyone can work on the Global Goals. What you do next decides whether that was an event — or a beginning.

- The GGJ Host ProgrammeNine modules at learn.globalgoalsjam.org, each ending in an artefact. The capstone assembles them into your complete jam plan — this book is its companion.
- The toolkit generatorglobalgoalsjam.org/toolkit — your agenda, method cards and printable pack, generated for your jam.
- The communityThe always-on space where hosts in 60+ countries trade formats and results. Your recap belongs there.

See you at the jam.



globalgoalsjam.org Co-founded with UNDP · Digital Society School · 2016